

Generate answer for github recover head ref



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Stack Overflow

<https://stackoverflow.com/questions/10228760/how-do-i-fix-a-git-detached-head>

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How do I fix a Git detached head? - Stack Overflow

Run git checkout master If you would like to incorporate the changes you made into master, run git merge tmp from the master branch. You should be on the master branch after running git checkout master. If you want to delete your changes associated with the detached HEAD You only need to...



Stack Overflow

<https://stackoverflow.com/questions/20815006/retrieve-lost-head-branch-in-git>

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Retrieve lost HEAD branch in git - Stack Overflow

I can't find it anywhere in SourceTree under All Branches, and git branch and git log on the command line only show my Master branch too. Is there anyway to get back my commits from my lost detached HEAD?



Git

<https://git-scm.com/docs/git-restore>

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Git - git-restore Documentation

By default, if --staged is given, the contents are restored from HEAD, otherwise from the index. Use --source to restore from a different commit. See "Reset, restore and revert" in git [1] for the differences between the three commands.



GitHub Docs

<https://docs.github.com/en/rest/git/refs>

...

REST API endpoints for Git references - GitHub Docs

A Git reference (git ref) is a file that contains a Git commit SHA-1 hash. When referring to a Git commit, you can use the Git reference, which is an easy-to-remember name, rather than the hash.



Git

<https://git-scm.com/book/en/v2/Git-Internals-Git-References>

...

Git - Git References

The HEAD The question now is, when you run git branch <branch>, how does Git know the SHA-1 of the last commit? The answer is the HEAD file. Usually the HEAD file is a symbolic reference to the branch you're currently on. By symbolic reference, we mean that unlike a normal reference, it contains a pointe...



knowledge lib.io

<https://knowledge lib.io/software/debugging/git-detached-head/2026>

...

How to Recover from Git Detached HEAD State | knowledge lib.io

Feb 23, 2026 · Complete guide to Git detached HEAD: what it is, 13-row command reference, decision tree, recovery via git switch -c and git reflog, anti-patterns, 3...



Git Cookbook

<https://git.seveas.net/recovering-from-a-detached-head.html>

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Recovering from a detached head - Git Cookbook

Unlike in real life, a detached head is pretty common in git. Find out how you can get into this situation and how to recover from it.

How do I fix a Git detached head

<https://stackoverflow.com/...>

Detached head means you are no longer on a branch, you have checked out a single commit in the history (in this case the commit previous to HEAD, i.e. HEAD^).

If you want to *keep* your changes associated with the **detached HEAD**

Run `git switch -c tmp` - this will save your changes in a new branch called tmp.

Run `git switch master`
If you would like to incorporate the changes you made into master, run `git merge tmp` from the master branch. You should be on the master branch after running `git switch master`.

If you want to *delete* your changes associated with the **detached HEAD**

You only need to checkout the branch you were on, e.g.

```
git switch master
```

Next time you have changed a file and want to restore it to the state it is in the index, don't delete the file first, just do

```
git restore --  
path/to/foo
```

This will restore the file foo to the state it is in the index.

```
--rtn
```

github

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Comprehensive Guide to Git HEAD Movement and Detached HE...

Nov 10, 2025 · For **HEAD** position errors caused by mistaken operations, git reflog combined with git checkout typically provides the safest recovery solution. When permanent reversion to a historical state is needed, git reset --hard offers thorough rollback capability but requires cautious use to avoid data...



How to Recover from a Corrupted Git Repository

Mar 29, 2026 · Step-by-step guide to diagnosing and recovering from Git repository corruption, from broken **HEAD** refs to damaged packfiles.

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